Hangouts Privacy Policy

Effective Date: January 14, 2026

This Privacy Policy describes how Hangouts (“the App,” “we,” “us,” or “our”) collects, uses, and protects personal information when users access or interact with our services.

---

1. Information We Collect

We collect the following categories of information to operate and enhance our services:

- **Personal Information:** First and last name, email address, and username.
- **Location Data:** Real-time location (when enabled) and specific location coordinates associated with content you choose to post.
- **User Content:** Images, captions, and location tags you upload to the Explore Page.
- **Friends’ Data:** First and last names, email addresses, and usernames of contacts you choose to connect with.

2. Use of Information

Collected information is used to:

- Enable user interactions and friend visibility features.
- Facilitate real-time location sharing and the "Explore Page" posting feature.
- Display usernames and shared content to your selected audience (Friends or Everyone).
- Maintain, improve, and personalize the App’s functionality and user experience.
- Ensure security, integrity, and reliability of services.

3. Information Sharing and Visibility

We provide different levels of visibility depending on how you use the App:

- **Usernames:** Your username is publicly visible to all users of the App.
- **Event Participation:** First and last names are visible only to participants within the same event.
- **Location Sharing:** Real-time location data is visible solely to approved friends and only when the user has opted in.
- **Explore Page Posts:** * If you share to **"Friends Only,"** your image, username, and the hangout location are visible only to your confirmed friends.
    - If you share to **"Everyone,"** your image, username, and the hangout location are visible to all users of the Hangouts App.

Hangouts does not sell, rent, or commercially share personal information with third parties.

4. Explore Page Content Guidelines

Users are expected to contribute to a safe community. When sharing images and locations:

- Ensure you have permission from others appearing in your photos.
- Avoid sharing images that reveal sensitive private locations (e.g., your home address).
- All content must comply with our Terms of Service regarding prohibited or harmful material.

5. Data Security

Appropriate technical and organizational measures are implemented to protect personal data against unauthorized access, alteration, disclosure, or destruction. While these measures meet industry standards, no system is completely secure, and users acknowledge inherent risks in transmitting data electronically.

6. User Controls and Data Management

Users maintain control over their data through the following:

- **Toggle Sharing:** Enable or disable real-time location sharing at any time.
- **Post Management:** Users can delete their Explore Page posts at any time, which removes the image and associated location data from the feed.
- **Account Updates:** Update or delete personal information within account settings.
- **Data Deletion:** Request permanent data deletion in accordance with applicable data protection laws.

7. Children's Privacy

The App is not directed toward individuals under the age of 13. We do not knowingly collect personal data from minors. If such data is inadvertently collected, it will be promptly deleted upon discovery.

8. Policy Updates

This Privacy Policy may be updated periodically to reflect changes in our practices or for legal, regulatory, or operational reasons. Updates will be communicated by revising the "Effective Date" above. Continued use of the App constitutes acceptance of the updated policy.